we are being made to feel that we are not doing business, but committing crime. Taking a signal from the top, lower-rung officers are knocking at our doors with a threat to close down business. Within four days of government formation, four licensed slaughterhouses—all 100 per cent export units—have been closed in UP. Authorities checking these slaughterhouses ordered their closure on such flimsy reasons as one non-functional CCTV camera, slight variation in building plan and so on. The government's officials come to check the slaughterhouses carrying locks and seals with them.' As AIMLEA representatives waited for an audience with the chief minister, they argued that, of the 5 lakh people they employed, only '25% of the workforce was Muslim. The rest are Hindus and mostly OBCs. About 50% employees are women.'[145]

There was another problem with the restrictions on cow slaughter. 'The meat industry is the by-product of the dairy business. Have you ever seen any buffalo loitering on the roads and eating plastic bags or garbage? It is just because buffalos, when they turn unproductive, are sold to slaughterhouses, while farmers leave their unproductive cows to wander. Since a farmer earns by selling even his unproductive buffalo, buffalo-rearing is on the rise while cows are becoming economically unviable. Of the total milk production, buffalos have a 55% share. If there is a threat to the meat industry, the dairy trade would also collapse and farmers would be the biggest losers. India is at the top in the dairy business because it tops in meat production.'[146]

The Union government diluted its restrictions on cow slaughter a year later, in April 2018, doing away with the clause on 'restrictions on sale of cattle for slaughter'.[147]

The Sangh and Swatantra

The Jan Sangh had toyed with a proposal for a merger with the Swatantra Party in 1964. This was during its years of leadership turmoil in the mid-1960s. *The Times of India* reported on 23 January 1964 that a 'proposal to merge the Swantantra Party with the Jan Sangh to form a new organisation, called the National Democratic Party is reported to be under consideration by its leaders. After a